

3. GO BACK-TO-SCHOOL SHOPPING

Kids or no kids, the back-to-school shopping season is filled with low-priced office supply opportunities! July through August is the best time to stock up on pens, pencils, highlighters, notebooks, rulers, white out, and everything else you can think of to help you be more productive in the office.

The best way to take advantage of this season is to grab a few circulars, head to your preferred store, and ask if they will match their competitors' sales prices. Most will do this, including Target and Walmart, and you'll avoid running from store to store trying to score the latest deals.

The key is to stock up on everything you need to last you until next year, when you can venture out and stock up again. Office goodies are never as low priced as they are during the back-to-school season, so it pays to head out and see what you can find!

4. RAID THE DOLLAR STORE

Any other time of year, the dollar store is one of the best places to find discount office supplies. My favorites to pick up there are index cards, folders, notebooks, and poster board. It sure beats the \$3-\$4 options found at Target and Walmart!

The dollar store's quality will be a little hit and miss, but you'll soon figure out which supplies are okay to buy there and which ones you should splurge on a little bit. For instance, I refuse to buy sticky notes outside the Post-It brand, because they either don't stick at all, or rip when I'm trying to use the next available sheet.

For other dollar-specific items, don't forget to check the Michaels and Target dollar sections. They both have some really cute note cards, stickers, and paper pads, and the quality isn't bad at all.

5. USE WHAT YOU HAVE